

Question 44 · Unit 3 · 8 Marks

Explain e-learning as a training method and state its major advantages.

Introduction

E-learning is training delivered through electronic media: learning management systems (LMS), online modules, virtual classrooms, webinars, and mobile learning. It may be self-paced or live (synchronous). It can stand alone or be blended with classroom and OJT. 21st-century HRD notes mention web-based training, mobile devices, webinars and social learning tools.

Detailed points

- 1. Nature of the method.** Digital content (text, video, quizzes, simulations) plus often tracking of who completed what. Good e-learning is instructional design, not PDF dumping.
- 2. Advantage — flexibility of time and place.** Staff on shifts or in many cities can learn without travel. Useful in India for multi-location firms.
- 3. Advantage — speed and scale.** The same compliance or product-update module can reach thousands quickly and consistently.
- 4. Advantage — cost over time.** High design cost at first; low cost per extra learner later. Repeat training becomes cheaper.
- 5. Advantage — standardisation and tracking.** Quality does not depend on whichever local trainer is free. LMS records scores and completion for evaluation and audit.
- 6. Advantage — personalisation and replay.** Learners repeat difficult parts; adaptive paths; micro-learning of 10 minutes. This helps mixed-ability groups.
- 7. Advantage — blending and 21st-century tools.** Can combine with webinars, mobile apps, wikis, communities of practice. Notes also mention 3D activities and social learning.
- 8. Limitations (to show balance).** Needs devices, connectivity, self-discipline, and good design. Weak for some interpersonal skills unless combined with role play. Transfer still needs boss support. Mention limits so the answer is not one-sided.

Conclusion. Define e-learning, list advantages (flexibility, scale, cost, consistency, tracking, personalisation, blending), add two limits, conclude it is powerful when designed and supported, not when it is only video lectures.